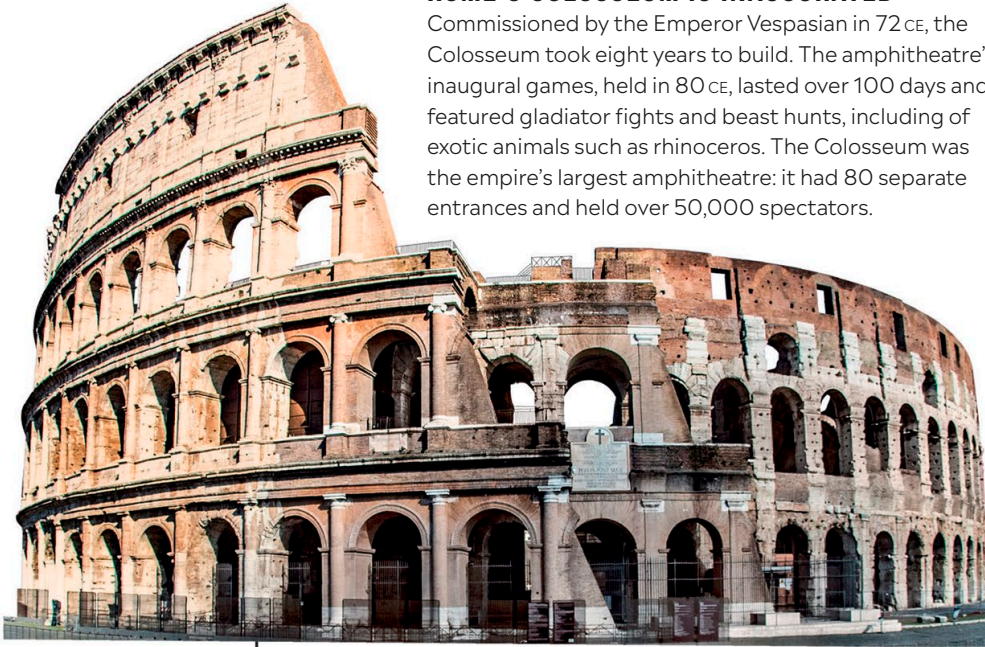


80 CE

ROME'S COLOSSEUM IS INAUGURATED

Commissioned by the Emperor Vespasian in 72 CE, the Colosseum took eight years to build. The amphitheatre's inaugural games, held in 80 CE, lasted over 100 days and featured gladiator fights and beast hunts, including of exotic animals such as rhinoceros. The Colosseum was the empire's largest amphitheatre: it had 80 separate entrances and held over 50,000 spectators.



△ The Colosseum, Rome



80 CE

100 CE The *Shuowen Jiezi*, the first dictionary to classify Chinese characters, is finished; it lists over 9,000 characters

c. 110 CE Envoys from India reportedly visit Emperor Trajan in Rome

▷ The Pyramid of the Sun, Teotihuacán



c. 100 CE

BUILDING OF THE PYRAMID OF THE SUN

The people of the central Mexican city of Teotihuacán constructed a vast pyramid on the eastern side of the Avenue of the Dead, the city's main thoroughfare. Over 70 m (230 ft) high, it was faced in limestone and painted with murals. The great building probably served as a temple; in 2013 a statue of the fire-god Huehuetēotl was found near its summit.